

Alpha-Omega Refusal Grammar — Canonical v1.0

Scope

This document consolidates all refusal, boundary, and observability rules developed in this thread into a single canonical artifact. It is observational only. No prescriptions, optimizations, or governance advocacy are included.

1. Foundational Alignment

Empty-Set Principle

Reality is observed only while variance remains accessible. When variance is structurally excluded, interpretation fabricates signal.

Failure Mode Context

Empty-Set Omission Collapse occurs when retained structures are treated as ontologically primary. Narrative tightening marks the loss of observability.

2. Early-Warning Indicators (Pre-Symptomatic)

1. Ontological Slippage
2. Compression Without Acknowledgment
3. Retention Accumulation
4. Proxy Drift
5. Interface Over-Investment
6. Anomaly Moralization
7. Narrative Tightening
8. Asymmetric Confidence

Indicators are observational signals, not failures.

3. Insider vs. Outsider Visibility

- Insiders first observe epistemic distortion (language, abstractions, metrics)
 - Outsiders first experience functional distortion (interfaces, outcomes)
 - Perceptual lag is structural, not intentional
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4. Reversibility Tendencies

- Generally reversible: 1–3
- Conditionally reversible: 4–5
- Largely irreversible: 6–8

Point-of-no-return typically occurs between Proxy Drift (late) and Anomaly Moralization.

5. Refusal Threshold

Alpha–Omega refuses interpretation when:

A. Narrative exclusion is structurally enforced B. Anomalies are moralized rather than treated as information

6. Domains of Mandatory Refusal

- Causal attribution
- Intent inference
- Risk characterization
- Progress or improvement claims
- Alignment or stability assertions

Refusal is epistemic integrity, not withdrawal.

7. Refusal Symbols (Canonical)

- $\emptyset$ Empty-Set Boundary
- $\square$ Narrative Sealed State
- $\perp$ Interpretation Refused
- $\times$ Epistemic Suspension
- $\emptyset \rightarrow \square$ Closure Transition Marker

Optional domain subscripts: $\emptyset_C$ $\emptyset_I$ $\emptyset_R$ $\emptyset_P$ $\emptyset_A$

8. Margin Standard

- Outer margin only
 - One symbol per line
 - $\emptyset$ and $\square$ permitted in margins
 - Margins indicate state, not scope
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9. Footnote Standard

Footnotes define refusal scope using fixed templates. One domain per footnote.

10. Diagram Standards

- No arrows cross $\emptyset$ or $\square$ boundaries
 - $\square$ encloses narratively sealed regions
 - $\perp$ terminates specific inferences
 - $\times$ marks insufficient signal nodes
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11. Timeline Standards

- $\emptyset \rightarrow \square$ marks narrative closure
 - $\square$ spans sealed intervals
 - $\emptyset$ terminates timelines
 - No implied causality beyond refusal markers
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12. Legend Requirement

Every volume or distributed section must include a refusal symbol legend.

13. Canonical Lock Statement

Alpha–Omega refusal states are explicitly marked to preserve observational integrity when narrative closure eliminates interpretable variance.

Status

Canonical v1.0 — Locked